towards Yamunotri. Here, one part of a fine-grained rock was carefully polished. Onto it were carved the first nine edicts in very small letters. Below this set, however, the letters become thrice as large as on the upper part (constituting edicts 10 to 14). And then, realizing that the original surface was too small for such large letters, the remaining record came to be carved on the left side of the rock as well. It is unlikely that the same hand inscribed all the edicts, or that they were inscribed simultaneously. It also seems that while initially the engraving was carefully crafted, the last four edicts were done sloppily.

A staggered engraving process can be seen at Shahbazgarhi in the present-day Mardan district of Pakistan. Here, unlike at Kalsi, more than one rock was used. Unlike both Erragudi and Kalsi, the Kharoshthi script was preferred. The first eleven edicts are on the east face of a large mass of trap rock up a hill.[18] The next is engraved on a separate boulder towards the foot of the hill, and the final two edicts (13 and 14) are on the west face of the same big rock up the hill whose eastern face was first inscribed. This west face was not suited to chiselling.[19] Why the scribe chose it and ignored the many other available rock surfaces eludes us. But their variant pattern of engraving, as well as the different sizes of letters in the three sets, shows a process of accrual, a progression stretched out.

Some 200 km to the east, at Mansehra in Hazara district, the pattern mimics the Shahbazgarhi form. Kharoshthi, the script considered better suited to the area, is used again. On the highest boulder, a well-polished square was created at the surface and upon this the first eight edicts were inscribed in very small characters.[20] The scribe who wrote on the second rock, located a little below the first, used large letters to engrave the texts of three edicts (9 to 11) on the north face and one edict (12) on its south face. The third rock, now in a fallen state, carried the last two edicts.

Such was not always the case. Occasionally, the edicts were simultaneously engraved at one place. In the most spectacular of these, at